Q+A

SHADES OF **GREY**

Bhumi Pednekkar *plays cop Rita Ferreira in Amazon Prime's crime drama* Daldal

Q. There are some parallels between Sophia in *The Royals* and Rita in *Daldal*. How do you see them?

Yes, they both are in a man's world trying to make their space, and both have their traumas. But *Daldal*'s world is different. Rita is grey, dark, broken and complex. She has violent thoughts, yet there's empathy in her. Every good thing that happens in her life she wants to destroy because she feels she's not worthy of it.

Q. The female-cop genre is thriving on streaming. How does *Daldal* stand out from the pack?

Daldal has none of the tropes you'd expect from the genre. It's a whydunit, a slow-burn of a psychological drama, yet it is so binge-able. I have watched all the female-led police shows and enjoyed them. I feel all of us are so frustrated with reality. So I love watching women thrash corrupt men.

Q. In 2025, there was a lack of strong female characters on the big screen. Is this why so many actresses are gravitating towards streaming?

I feel it starts with the audience. The onus is put on makers and actors. I have had female-led comedies that people didn't go watch in theatres. There are hordes of films which are hypermasculine. It worries me. If I were to debut in current times, I don't think I would survive 10 years. Thank god for thriving platforms and female-led narratives in the series space.

Q. How's 2026 shaping up for you?

Last year for me was recalibrating who I am. There was a lot of educating myself, having varied experiences and putting myself in a room where I am the least intelligent person. I am not chasing clout, quantity, crazy cheques but good work that I can be proud of. In a world that's all about fakery, I want to find my truth. I get back to set in a month.

—with ***Suhani Singh***



Photograph by BANDEEP SINGH